

Interactive Digital Art and Design SE608

Project Proposal Year IV



Student Name:	Sophia Stanley	Student Number:	C00299461
Working Title:	Rhythm Rangers		
Description:	Lucius, Bella, and Devon are the 3 members of the rock band “Live BreakDown” (LBD), hoping to make a name for themselves enough to enter the prestigious Rockwarm Music Festival. One day they are greeted by a mysterious woman named Euterpe, who claims to be from another world named Music World, which was recently destroyed by the evil organisation, Archival Incense! After destroying Music World, Incense has come to Earth World to destroy them too, but there is one thing that can stop them... LBD?! She gives LBD transformation devices that turn them into super rangers! They might not believe Euterpe at first, but once they encounter monsters from Music World and transform for the first time, they start thinking they really CAN save the world! Lucius armed with a microphone-axe, Bella with drumstick-clubs, and Devon with a guitar-sword, they set forth on a journey to save the world and Rockwarm Festival! <u>Art:</u> • Story section with in-engine, 3D cutscenes featuring low poly, rigged and animated 3D characters, items, and environments. These will lead into the battle sections • Story sections also feature 2D sprites for each character, as well as a 2D text box for dialogue and descriptions. • Music will be made by me in GarageBand. I will have a title song and a battle song, and specific jingles for each attack input. There are plans to add more music in the future. <u>Battle Mechanics:</u> • In the battle section, you play as 3 heroes: the Red, Blue, and Yellow rangers. You can either Attack (which does a basic attack that costs 0 Power), use Powered Attacks (which cost Power but deal more damage and/or other effects like buffs or debuffs), or Block (which lowers the damage and meter loss you would take from an incoming attack). Each hero has 3 stats: HP (health), Power Meter (explained below), and Speed (determines the attack order for heroes and enemies). Your enemies will typically only have HP and Speed, but if they are able to use magic, they will have their own Power Meter. • Your heroes start out transformed with a maxed out “Power Meter.” This meter allows them to stay transformed and use their more powerful magic attacks. The meter depletes when using Powered attacks and taking damage. Some enemies will also have debuffs that lower the meter. When the meter reaches 0, that hero will detransform. They will		

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still be able to fight, but they will not have access to Powered attacks and their basic attack will be weaker. An untransformed hero will regain Power every turn and will regain more when Blocking. When their meter is maxed out, they will once again transform.

- When you select an attack, a rhythm-game style section will occur. Hit the arrow keys/WASD keys that correspond to where the notes are falling. If you miss too many notes, your attack will fail. If you hit every note perfectly, your attack will be stronger than usual, either increasing damage or effects!
- Basic Attacks will have more simple notes to hit, making them more reliable for consistent damage. Powered Attacks will have more complicated notes, providing extra challenge but much greater rewards if successful. Blocking does not require hitting notes.
- There will be different types of notes depending on the attack you're using or buffs you have received. For example, there will be a chance to find a green note that, when hit, will heal the hero. Certain enemies will be able to spawn "bad notes" that will hurt you or your combo if you hit them, so you should let them miss.

Inputs:

- The game will have support for keyboards and Playstation 4 controllers. The story sections are styled more similarly to a visual novel, as in you will be reading the dialogue and pressing the A button/Enter key to go to the next line. There will also be an option to skip the dialogue and go straight to the battle. Battles are not skippable.
- In the battle sections, you can use the typical movement keys/buttons (WASD, Arrow Keys) to select whether you will attack, defend, or use a Powered attack. When you select an attack and there are multiple enemies, you can also use these keys to select which enemy to attack.
- When you select an attack, a new section appears with 4 top-down lanes, similar to rhythm games like Beatmania. Notes will fall down in each lane, and you can press the D, F, J, and K keys to hit notes in the lanes. Each button corresponds to a different lane. If you hit the wrong button for the wrong lane, you will miss, and if you hit any other keys, you will also miss.
- Both the story and the battle scenes will have fixed positioning, so there will not be any need to move the player characters around. In my mind, the player is more of a "commander" to the heroes, letting them make the moves they need to complete their own story, rather than the player themselves being part of the story.
- Keybind mapping is planned to be added, allowing players to customise the inputs to whatever feels most comfortable for them.

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Reasons for selecting project:	I am a fan of Power Rangers and superhero teams in general, so I have wanted to make a story featuring my own original team. I also enjoy turn-based RPGS, and I think adding a rhythm game element is something I think will be both a challenging mechanic to make and end up with a fun game. I have not used Unity3D before but I know it is very good for game development so I wanted to get experience in using it. I want to do more 3D modelling and combined with our 3D modelling modules we will have this year, I would love to apply the skills I will learn into my project. I made a few songs for my project last semester, and I would like to make some more songs for this game.
Proposed research content:	For this project, I would like to look at " <i>Research on the design of third-person 3D action role-playing games</i> " by Hao-Xiang Xu et al. This research was made to apply to making an RPG using Blender and Unity3D, two programs I was already planning to use.
External links (if applicable):	Research on the design of third-person 3D action role-playing games
Hardware requirements:	College Computer (Linux) Personal Laptop (Windows) iPad + Apple Pencil (owned)
Software requirements:	Procreate (2D Art) Blender (3D Art) Unity3D (Game Development) GarageBand (Music)
Other requirements:	

Signed: Sophia Stanley

Date: 24/09/2026

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Approved/Not Approved:	
Reasons for not approving project:	
Conditions attached to approving project:	

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Approved/Not Approved:		
Name of Supervisor:		
Signed: _____	Date: _____	

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Actions Taken

1. *Alternative input mechanisms should be investigated instead of relying only on the Guitar Hero controller.*

Instead of using a Guitar Hero controller, I will instead use the D, F, J, and K keys to hit notes that correspond to four different lanes.

2. *An input method should be selected that fits naturally with the RPG gameplay and supports player immersion.*

Using the keyboard and controllers fits naturally with RPGs as this is how most standard RPGs would work. Many players would be familiar with it and will not have to learn too much to get immersed in the world.

3. *The revised proposal should explain how the selected interaction mechanism will be used during battles and how it affects the game outcome.*

I hope I explained that well in the Inputs section above.

4. *The proposal should show how the proposed interaction differs from a standard rhythm-game implementation and from previous music-game projects.*

I think combining the rhythm gameplay with an RPG creates a unique experience. Instead of a typical rhythm game where you would have 1 long song to play, it is instead done in short bursts that can either help or hinder your RPG gaming experience.

5. *The revised interaction mechanism should be clearly described as a central technical and design feature of the FYP.*

I do not think I emphasised this enough in my original proposal, but I want the focus of my technical feature to be learning how to use Unity to make an RPG with rhythm elements and an interesting story. Since I do not have much experience in programming in C#, I think it would be a good thing to focus on and help me develop more employable skills. Even if Unity has fallen out of favour recently, I think learning C# and knowing how to get my way around Unity will still be quite beneficial in the long run.

For the design feature, I want to focus on improving both my 3D and 2D art. 2D art is what I have been passionate about for years, and I want to make 2D sprites for all the characters and UI elements. I have limited experience in Blender and want to be able to make stylish and expressive 3D models and environments. I would rather those be my focus than creating a unique interaction method.